1. Clare W. Graves — “Levels of Existence: An Open System Theory of Values” (1970).

’I’he notion that much of man’s current behavior is immoral and unethical is, as I see it, based on a premise consisting of three parts:
I. That beneath it all man is a beast driven by original sin, agressiveness, and a death instinct.
II. That civilized human behavior, good values, can only be superimposed on man and therefore must be constantly imposed upon him lest his animalism override his humanism.
III. That these good values, Judeo-Christian ethics, Buddhist principles or the like, have been revealed to man and are the prime tenets by which he should live.

Another author’s framework that he proposes:

I. That man’s nature is not a set thing, that it is ever emergent, that it is an open system, not a closed system.
II. That man’s nature evolves by saccadic, quantum-like jumps from one steady state system to another.
III. That man’s values change from system to system as his total psychology emerges in new form with each quantum-like jump to a new steady state of being.

Thus, an adult lives in a potentially open system of needs, values and aspirations, but he often settles into what approximates a closed system. When he is in any one level, he has only the behavioral degrees of freedom afforded him at that level.

The mature human being develops by subordinating older behavioral systems to newer, higher-order systems. Each level is a state of equilibrium with its own appropriate acts, feelings, motivations, ethics, values, thoughts, and management preferences. People may stabilize at a level, regress, or show a level’s behavior in positive or negative form. Societies and individuals may be mixed across levels.

The levels and value systems

A-N: Automatic / Reactive — physiological survival; purely reactive values; no conscious moral “ought.”
B-O: Tribalistic / Traditionalistic — safety through tradition, elders, ritual, myth; values are concrete and rigid.
C-P: Egocentric / Exploitive — self-awareness and survival; power, heroism, “might is right”; exploitive values.
D-Q: Saintly / Sacrificial — security through sacrifice and prescribed rules; salvation, denial, piety, self-discipline.
E-R: Materialistic — independence through rational control of the physical world; scientism, achievement, materialism.
F-S: Sociocentric / Sociocratic — belonging and community with valued others; sensitivity, communication, social approval.
G-T: Cognitive / Existential — first “being” level; threshold between animal-like and distinctly human existence; accepting reality, existence, pluralism, deep democracy.
H-U: Experientialistic — second being level; experience, communion, wonder, awe, receptive perception, enlarged consciousness.

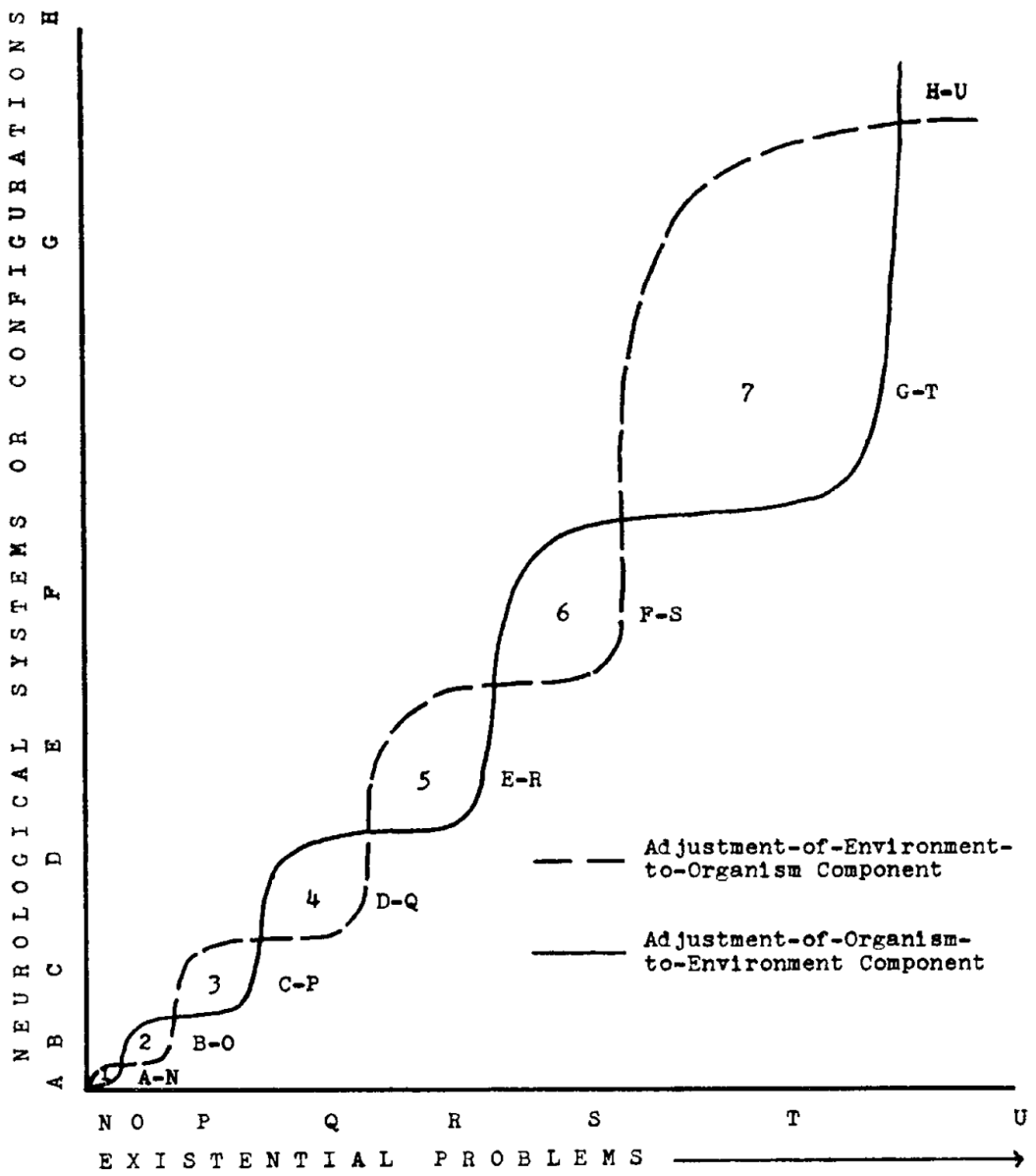



FIGURE 1 Emergence of the Existential States from the interaction of Components as Existential Problems N—U Are Solved and as Neurological Systems or Configurations A—H Are Involved.

Value change is regressive-progressive. When old values no longer fit new existential conditions, people may regress, disorganize, and confront the old establishment before consolidating a new value system. Thus riots, dissent, confrontation, and rejection of older values can be signs of reorganization for growth, not simply decay. Three conditions for change: insight, removal of barriers, and consolidating factors.

Ethical and moral “decline” is better understood as the retention of existentially inappropriate values during profound transformation—not necessarily as the breakdown and discard of “the old.”

2. Don Beck & Christopher Cowan — Spiral Dynamics: Mastering Values, Leadership, and Change. (Summary of Spiral Dynamics by Don Beck and Christopher Cowan by Steve Dinan, Esalen Institute)

1. Beige: Semi-Stone Age not generally that active today, dominated by nature and basic survival instincts, acting much as other animals. Results in loose, clan-based survival groups. Famine might result in large numbers of people arrested in this mode. (newborns and senile elderly, mentally ill street people, people in starvation, late-stage Alzheimers, .1% of population)

2. Purple: Tribal animistic, magical, spiritistic, close to the earth and cyclic in outlook. This leads to tribal groupings, focus on rituals to appease ancestral spirits. Blood bonds are strong. Management of PURPLE demands respect for clan rules and allegiances, respect to the clan "leaders." Rewarding someone too visibly can break the group bond with negative consequences. Change must be embodied in rituals, traditions, and symbols. (guardian angels and voodoo-like curses, blood oaths, lucky charms, superstitions, athletic team bonding, 10% of world population, 1% of power)

3. Red: Exploitative Rough and harsh, rugged authoritarianism, finds expression in slavery or virtual slavery, exploitation of unskilled labor. Generally run by a Top Boss and series of proxies, strict division of have's and have not's. Assumption is that people are lazy, must be forced to work. True leaders must suppress natural human tendencies. Currently evident in street life and gangs in inner cities. Motivated by "heroes" and conquest. Feudalism. (Terrible Twos, feudal kingdoms, soldiers of fortune, many rock stars, Power Rangers, rebellious youth, 20% of world population, 5% of power)

4. Blue: Authoritarian Loyal to Truth, which is defined by social grouping. Purposeful and patriotic, leads people to obey authority, feel guilty when not conforming to group norms, try to serve the greater good through self-sacrifice. Works very well in industrial economies. Discipline is strict but usually fair and often public (flogging in Singapore, e.g.). U.S. has shifted away from BLUE industries, which have moved to Mexico, Taiwan, Malaysia, and elsewhere that this BLUE is now strong. BLUE industries will eventually move to Africa, in Beck's opinion. Moralistic-prescriptive management techniques. Organizational structure is pyramidal. (Boy and Girl Scouts, Billy Graham, Puritan American, Confucian China, Islamic fundamentalism, 40% of world population, 30% of power)

5. Orange: Entrepreneurial Personal success orientation, each person rationally calculating what is to their personal advantage. Motivations are largely economic, people are responsive to perks, bonuses, money rather than loyalty, group belongingness, or life employment. Rational capacities allow people to test many options. Competition improves productivity and fosters growth. This is probably the dominant vMeme in America today. Main concerns are autonomy and manipulation of the environment. Usually results in free market economy and multi-party democracy. (Ayn Rand, Wall Street, Rodeo Drive, cosmetics industry, Dallas, trophy hunting, Hong Kong, GQ, Mediterranean yachts, 30% of world population, 50% of power)

6. Green: Communitarian Sensitive and humanistic, the focus with green is community and personal growth, equality, attention to environmental concerns. Work is motivated by human

contact and contribution, learning from others. Being liked is more important than competitive advantage, value openness and trust, fear rejection and disapproval. Leaders become facilitators, less autocratic. Hierarchies blur in the move towards egalitarianism with a resulting tendency towards inefficiency and stagnation. Can become so bogged down and ineffectual, though, that people revert to go-getter individualism of orange. (Rogerian counseling, Esalen, GreenPeace, Jacques Costeau, Jimmy Carter, John Lennon's music, Doctors without Borders, ACLU, Ben & Jerry's, animal rights, deep ecology, 10% of population, 15% of power)

7. Yellow: Systemic This is the first vMeme of the second tier (described below) in which there is a quantum shift in the capacity to take multiple perspectives in life. YELLOW is motivated by learning for its own sake and is oriented towards integration of complex systems. Change is a welcome part of the process in organizations and life; YELLOW likes the challenges. It is characterized by systems thinking, an orientation to how parts interact to create a greater whole. Unique talents and dispositions are honored as contributing something valuable to the whole. YELLOW likes engineering complex systems and dealing with ideas. It is also ecologically oriented, but in a more subdued, behind the scenes way. YELLOW thinkers often work on the periphery of organizations, quietly fine-tuning situations and procedures, much to the bafflement of the first tier vMemes. (Hawking's Brief History of Time, chaos theory, eco-industrial parks, Wired magazine, 1% of world population, 5% of power)

8. Turquoise: Holistic Focused on a global holism/integralism, attuned to the delicate balance of interlocking life forces. Synthetic and experiential, emerging focus on spiritual connectivity. Work must be meaningful to the overall health of life. Feelings and information experienced together, enhancing both. Able to see and honor many perspectives, including many of the "lower" vMemes. Structured in multi-dimensional ways. Conscious of energy fields, holographic links in all walks of work and life, urge to use collective human intelligence to work on large-scale problems without sacrificing individuality. (Gaia hypothesis, Ken Wilber's work, Teilhard de Chardin, David Bohm, McLuhan's ‘global village,' Gandhi's idea of pluralistic harmony, not very influential yet, .1% of world population, 1% of power)

3. Sergey Litti / Litti Pro — “Spiral Dynamics. Teal Organizations. Change Management”

| Level | Organizational emphasis | Leadership and coordination | Strengths / possible limitations |
|---|---|---|---|
| Beige | Immediate survival | Reactive behavior focused on basic needs | Primarily background to the model rather than a developed corporate arrangement |

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| Purple | Belonging and loyalty | Paternal leadership, traditions, informal relationships | Cohesion and mutual care / dependence on the leader and unclear responsibility |
| Red | Power and personal authority | Centralized decisions, direct control, loyal executors | Energy and speed / suppressed initiative, leader overload |
| Blue | Order and stability | Defined roles, procedures, accountability | Predictability and coordination / bureaucracy and rules becoming ends in themselves |
| Orange | Achievement and competition | Strategic leadership, performance goals, project-based coordination | Initiative, flexibility, growth / burnout and destructive internal competition |
| Green | Agreement and shared concern | Participatory leadership, equality, collaboration | Loyalty and mutual development / slow decisions and difficulty resolving trade-offs |
| Yellow | Integration and contextual flexibility | Combining approaches from earlier levels according to circumstances | Alignment of goals, rules, strategies, and relationships |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Turquoise | Self-organization and responsibility | Employees take responsibility for processes and coordinate their contributions | Emphasis on distributed responsibility; detailed mechanisms require further study |